FUTURES MATTER EDUCATION

Futures Matter - Northwood, 122 Emily Street, Highgate, Birmingham, B12 0XJ

Preventing Extremism and Radicalisation Policy

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1.0 AIMS

Futures Matter - Northwood is committed to keeping every pupil safe, including from being drawn into extremism or terrorism. We know that extremism and radicalisation are safeguarding concerns, in the same way as other forms of harm. There is no place for extremist views of any kind in our school, whether they come from pupils, staff, governors, parents, visitors or outside organisations.

The Prevent duty does not require a separate policy, and the main safeguarding arrangements are in section 17 and Appendices 4 and 5 of our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy. We have written this policy to bring those arrangements together, and to explain how we apply them to our setting and our pupils. This policy aims to:

- make sure that pupils who may be at risk of radicalisation are identified early and given the right support
- set out how concerns are raised, assessed and, where needed, referred
- explain how we build pupils' resilience, and keep our school a place where they can talk about difficult ideas safely
- be proportionate, and based on what we know about our pupils and our local area

2.0 LEGISLATION AND GUIDANCE

- Counter-Terrorism and Security Act 2015, section 26 (the Prevent duty: to have due regard to the need to prevent people from being drawn into terrorism) and section 38 (the duty to co-operate with Channel)
- The Prevent duty guidance for England and Wales (2023), including paragraphs 161 to 164 on schools
- Keeping Children Safe in Education 2026
- The Education (Independent School Standards) Regulations 2014, in particular the standard on the spiritual, moral, social and cultural development of pupils, which includes respect for democracy, the rule of law, individual liberty and mutual respect and tolerance
- Terrorism Act 2000 and Terrorism Act 2006
- Equality Act 2010
- DfE guidance on understanding and identifying radicalisation risk in your education setting, and on the Prevent duty and safeguarding learners vulnerable to radicalisation
- The Home Office guidance on making a Prevent referral and on the Channel programme

3.0 WHAT WE MEAN BY

Term	Meaning
Radicalisation	The process by which a person comes to support terrorism and extremist ideologies associated with terrorist groups (Keeping Children Safe in Education).

Term	Meaning
Extremism	As defined in the Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy, Appendix 4. It includes vocal or active opposition to fundamental British values, and the promotion of an ideology based on violence, hatred or intolerance. Extremism is more than simply holding strong or unpopular views. To confirm which government definition of extremism the school will use, as the Safeguarding Policy uses the 2011 definition.
Terrorism	An action or threat that endangers or causes serious violence to a person, causes serious damage to property, or seriously disrupts an electronic system, that is designed to influence the government or to intimidate the public, and is made to advance a political, religious or ideological cause (Terrorism Act 2000).
Prevent	The part of the government's counter-terrorism strategy that aims to stop people from becoming terrorists or supporting terrorism, by supporting those who are susceptible to it early.
Channel	A multi-agency programme that provides support to people who are at risk of being drawn into terrorism. It is led locally by the police counter-terrorism unit, and the local authority runs a panel to decide what support is needed. Taking part is voluntary.
Susceptibility	How open a person is to being drawn into extremist views, because of their personal circumstances, needs, experiences or influences. We use this word rather than saying a pupil is a risk.

Entries in the table above that say To confirm or Add still need completing.

4.0 ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Who	Responsibilities
The Proprietor and the School Governance Board	Make sure the school meets the Prevent duty and has suitable procedures, training, filtering and monitoring and risk assessment. Support the school's ethos and values. Receive a report from the Head Teacher at least once a year. Take Prevent awareness training. Review this policy each year.
The Head Teacher	Is the Prevent single point of contact (SPOC) and the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL). Makes sure staff, governors and volunteers are trained and know what to do. Carries out the Prevent risk assessment (see section 5). Makes sure pupils learn about extremism and resilience. Makes referrals, works with the police, the local authority and Channel, and takes part in Channel panel meetings.
The Deputy DSL (Carrie-Ann McGurk, Proprietor)	Acts when the DSL is not available, and supports the DSL. Oversees the Prevent risk assessment on behalf of the Board.

Who	Responsibilities
All staff and volunteers	Complete Prevent training, are alert to signs of concern, raise any concern with the DSL straight away, and challenge prejudice and extremist views. Staff do not investigate a concern themselves and do not promise to keep it secret.
Pupils	Respect others, tell a trusted adult if they are worried about something they see or hear, and understand that unkind or hateful language will be challenged.

5.0 UNDERSTANDING OUR RISK

There is no single route into extremism, and nowhere is free from risk. The DSL assesses how likely it is that pupils could be drawn into terrorism, using what we know about our pupils, our community and the local area. We record this in a Prevent risk assessment, which is part of our risk assessments (see the Risk Assessments Policy). The Head Teacher holds the assessment, reviews it each year, and reviews it when circumstances change or after a concern. **The Prevent risk assessment is still to be written.**

The DSL keeps in touch with local safeguarding partners, including the police and the local authority, to understand the local picture. The DSL also considers the effect of:

- our pupils' needs. Pupils with social, emotional and mental health needs and autism may find it harder to read the intentions of others, may have intense special interests, may feel isolated or misunderstood, and may spend a lot of time online. Some may be more open to people who offer belonging, identity or answers. Staff must not assume that a pupil is at risk because of their needs, and must not miss a risk because it is put down to their needs
- family, peer group, community and online influences, including in the local community
- the curriculum, our online safety and filtering systems, visiting speakers and any use of the building by others
- the pupils' history, including trauma, loss, discrimination or grievance

6.0 SIGNS THAT MAY CAUSE CONCERN

Radicalisation can happen quickly or over a long time, and can happen online or in person. Extremist ideologies of every kind are covered, including Islamist, far right, domestic and other. Signs are often small, and one on its own may not mean anything. Staff look at the whole picture and the context, and the guidance in Appendix 4 of the Safeguarding Policy. Examples include a pupil:

- expressing sympathy for extremist causes or glorifying violence
- repeating the language of extremist groups or hateful terms, or using them to exclude or threaten others
- showing intolerance of difference, such as faith, race, gender, disability or sexuality, or pressing their views on others
- possessing or sharing extremist literature, symbols, graffiti or images, or searching for them online

- becoming withdrawn, secretive or losing interest in friends and activities, or changing their friends, behaviour or appearance in a way that is out of character
- talking about contact with extremist people or groups, or wanting to join or support one
- reporting that a family member or friend holds extremist views, or a parent asking for help about changes in their child
- showing a sense of grievance, injustice or not belonging that is being exploited by others

Staff also remember that a pupil may show these signs for other reasons, such as exploration of ideas, a special interest, trauma, or a need linked to their autism or SEMH. The aim is to understand and support the pupil, not to label them.

7.0 WHAT TO DO IF YOU HAVE A CONCERN

Step	What happens
1. Raise it	Any member of staff, volunteer, governor or contractor who has a concern about a pupil, or about an adult, tells the DSL straight away, in person or by phone, and records it on CPOMS the same day (the concern form in Appendix 1 can be used as a guide). If the DSL is not available, tell the Deputy DSL.
2. Immediate danger	If someone is in immediate danger, or a crime is being committed, call 999. The anti-terrorist hotline is 0800 789 321.
3. Assess	The DSL gathers the information we already hold, speaks to the staff involved, and where it is safe and sensible to do so talks to the pupil and the family. The DSL decides whether the concern is about a possible risk of radicalisation, or another safeguarding or behaviour matter.
4. Decide	The DSL decides the right response: support within school (for example through the pupil's plan, key adult, mentoring, curriculum or a restorative conversation), advice from a Prevent contact, or a Prevent referral. Where a concern is a general safeguarding concern, it is dealt with under the Safeguarding Policy. The DSL can seek advice from the police Prevent team or the local authority Prevent lead at any stage, without making a referral. Add the local contact details in Appendix 2.
5. Refer	If the DSL thinks a pupil is at risk of being drawn into terrorism, they make a Prevent referral, using the national referral form. The referral goes to the police and is considered for Channel. The DSL tells the pupil's placing authority and social worker, and normally tells the parents or carers, unless doing so would put the pupil at risk.
6. Support and follow up	The DSL takes part in any Channel meeting, shares relevant information in line with data protection law, carries out the actions agreed, and keeps a record of what was decided and why. The school supports the pupil throughout, and keeps their education going.

Step	What happens
7. Record and review	All concerns, decisions and referrals are recorded securely on CPOMS, including when we decide not to refer and why. The DSL reviews the outcome and any lessons for the school.

Entries in the table above that say To confirm or Add still need completing.

Concerns about a member of staff, a governor or a volunteer are reported to the Head Teacher, or if the concern is about the Head Teacher, to the Chair of the School Governance Board, and dealt with under the Allegations section of the Safeguarding Policy. Such a concern may also be reported to the police.

The DfE has a dedicated helpline for non-emergency advice about extremism in education, on 020 7340 7264 or counter.extremism@education.gov.uk. **Check the details before use.**

8.0 TEACHING AND CURRICULUM

We help pupils to build resilience to extremism, and a positive sense of identity, through good teaching and a calm and trusting relationship with adults. We promote the values of democracy, the rule of law, individual liberty, and mutual respect and tolerance of those with different faiths and beliefs. We do this by:

- a personal development, relationships and citizenship programme that includes the law, rights and responsibilities, respect for difference, and how to stay safe online
- teaching pupils to think critically, to ask questions about what they read and see, and to spot bias and misinformation, including on social media
- providing a safe space for pupils to talk about, and challenge, controversial issues, taught in a balanced way and adapted to each pupil's understanding and needs
- using restorative approaches and teaching peaceful ways to resolve disagreement
- celebrating the different backgrounds, cultures and beliefs in our school community, and challenging stereotypes
- making sure that teachers are confident to deal with difficult questions, and do not shut down a conversation without addressing it
- helping pupils to feel valued, included and part of a community, as this is the best protection against being drawn in by others

Prejudice, discrimination, and extremist or hateful language by pupils or staff will always be challenged, and dealt with under the Behaviour, Rewards and Sanctions Policy or the Staff Code of Conduct. Where the cause is a pupil's need, we respond with support as well as consequences.

9.0 ONLINE SAFETY

Pupils do not have to meet anyone in person to be drawn into extremist views, and extremist groups use social media, gaming and messaging to reach young people. Our filtering and monitoring (provided by Senso, which integrates with CPOMS) blocks extremist content and alerts us to attempts to reach it, as set out in the Filtering and Monitoring Policy and the Online Safety and Acceptable Use Policy. Alerts are reviewed by the DSL. We teach pupils how to stay safe online, and we talk to parents about the risks and what they can do at

home. Any concern about extremist material is reported to the DSL straight away. Advice on online safety for pupils, parents and staff is available from Kids Online World. Out of school hours, staff follow the out-of-hours protocol in Appendix 8 of the Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy.

10.0 VISITORS, SPEAKERS AND USE OF THE PREMISES

- All visitors sign in and are supervised. Any outside speaker, organisation or resource used with pupils is agreed in advance by the Head Teacher, who carries out open source checks (for example internet and social media searches) to make sure they do not promote views that go against our values.
- We do not work with, or use materials from, any group that promotes extreme positions, for example by encouraging hatred, violence or breaking the law, by promoting systems that oppose democracy, or by presenting biased information to make accusations against institutions without evidence.
- If such a group is mentioned in a lesson, perhaps because a pupil asks, the teacher will discuss it fairly and carefully explain what makes its position extreme.
- If any part of our premises is used by an outside group, we check who they are and what they will do, and we do not allow use by a group that promotes extremist views.
- Educational visits are risk assessed, including for terror threats and the suitability of the venue and its people (see the Educational Visits Policy).

11.0 STAFF, GOVERNORS AND TRAINING

- We follow safer recruitment practice (see the Safeguarding Policy, section 13). This helps to stop people with extremist views being in a position of trust.
- All staff, governors and volunteers complete Prevent awareness training when they start, and refresher training at least every two years. They are updated when guidance changes. The DSL and Deputy DSL complete more advanced Prevent training and update their knowledge regularly. The Head Teacher keeps a record. **To confirm the training provider.**
- Staff are shown how to recognise signs of concern, how to challenge extremist views safely and how to raise a concern.
- Misconduct by a member of staff, such as promoting extremist views, will be dealt with under the Staff Code of Conduct and the Safeguarding Policy, and may be reported to the police, the local authority designated officer or the Teaching Regulation Agency.

12.0 SHARING INFORMATION

Information about a pupil may be shared with the police, the local authority, the placing authority and Channel where it is necessary to keep the pupil or others safe. This is lawful under data protection law, which does not stop us sharing information to safeguard a child (see the Data Protection Policy). We share only what is needed, record why, and keep records secure. We tell families what we are doing unless that would put the pupil at risk.

13.0 MONITORING AND REVIEW

The Head Teacher, as DSL and SPOC, monitors how this policy works, by looking at concerns and referrals, training, the Prevent risk assessment, and filtering and monitoring

reports. The Head Teacher reports to the School Governance Board each year, without including names. This policy is reviewed every year by the Head Teacher and approved by the School Governance Board, and sooner if the law or guidance changes.

14.0 LINKS WITH OTHER POLICIES

- Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy (section 17 and Appendices 4 and 5)
- Online Safety and Acceptable Use Policy and Filtering and Monitoring Policy
- Behaviour, Rewards and Sanctions Policy and Anti-Bullying Policy
- Staff Code of Conduct
- Risk Assessments Policy (Prevent risk assessment)
- Educational Visits Policy
- Data Protection Policy
- Curriculum Policy and SEND Policy

References: Home Office, Prevent duty guidance for England and Wales (2023); DfE, Keeping children safe in education; DfE, Understanding and identifying radicalisation risk in your education setting; The Key, Preventing extremism policies.

15.0 APPENDICES

Appendix 1: Prevent Concern Form

Appendix 2: Local Prevent Contacts

APPENDIX 1: PREVENT CONCERN FORM

This form is a guide. Record the concern on CPOMS the same day, and tell the DSL in person or by phone straight away. Write down what you saw or heard, in the pupil's own words where possible, and do not include opinions.

CONCERN	
Name of the person raising the concern, role, and the date and time:	
Pupil (or adult) the concern is about:	
What was seen, heard or reported, where, and when (use exact words):	
Was anyone else present or involved? Did a pupil say anything to anyone else?:	
Any online activity, material, symbols or items involved:	
Anything else that is different or has changed for the pupil, including friends, behaviour, appearance or home:	
What you did, and who you told:	
DSL ASSESSMENT (completed by the DSL)	
Information already known about the pupil, including needs, history and the EHC plan:	
Discussion with the pupil, family or others (who, when, what was said):	
Assessment: is this a possible risk of being drawn into terrorism, or another safeguarding or behaviour concern?:	
Advice sought (police Prevent team, local authority Prevent lead, placing authority) and the advice given:	
Decision: support within school, further monitoring, or a Prevent referral (give the reasons):	
If referred: date, referral reference, who was told (placing authority, social worker, parents or carers):	
Actions agreed, who will do them, and the review date:	
Outcome, and any lessons for the school:	

APPENDIX 2: LOCAL PREVENT CONTACTS

Contact	Details
Emergency	999. Anti-terrorist hotline 0800 789 321.
Police (non-emergency)	101. West Midlands Police Counter-Terrorism Unit (Prevent team). Add direct contact details.
Birmingham City Council Prevent lead	Add name and contact details.
Birmingham children's services (Multi Agency Safeguarding Hub)	Add contact details.
Placing local authorities and social workers	Add, or say where the list is kept.
DfE helpline for extremism in education	020 7340 7264, counter.extremism@education.gov.uk
Prevent training	Add the training provider or the online course used.

Entries in the table above that say To confirm or Add still need completing.